

ERICA NIEMIEC SKELTON

niemiec.er@northeastern.edu | ORCID ID: 0009-0009-8025-9357

EDUCATION

- 2024-2029 **Doctor of Philosophy** (expected)
Psychology, Northeastern University, Boston, MA
- 2026 **Master of Science**
Psychology, Northeastern University, Boston, MA
- 2022 **Post-baccalaureate Certificate**
Graduate Foundations in Psychology, Columbia University, New York, NY
- 2009 **Bachelor of Arts**
Classical Civilization, Latin, with Honors, University of Minnesota Twin Cities,
Minneapolis, MN

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2024-present **Graduate Student Researcher**, Learning and Brain Development Laboratory
Northeastern University
Advisor: Dr. Juliet Davidow
Research Focus: Development of neural systems supporting reward-related learning and goal-directed behavior; influence of social and prosocial motivations on risky decision-making; computational modeling and neuroimaging methods
- 2022-2024 **Lab Manager**, Developmental Affective Neuroscience Laboratory
Columbia University
Advisor: Dr. Nim Tottenham
Research Focus: Adaptations in executive function following caregiving-related early-life adversity; resilience through emotion regulation following severe early-life adversity; longitudinal development and neuroimaging methods
- 2020-2022 **Research Assistant**, Developmental Affective Neuroscience Laboratory
Columbia University
Advisor: Dr. Nim Tottenham
Research Focus: Cognitive and affective development following caregiving-related early-life adversity
- Summer 2021 **Research Intern**, Summer Internship Program in Psychological Science
Columbia University
Advisors: Anna Vannucci, Dr. Nim Tottenham
Research Focus: Associations between mentorship and anxious behaviors in children with heterogeneous early caregiving experiences

WORK EXPERIENCE

- 2013-2022 **Student Services Manager**, Brownsville Middle School
Achievement First
- 2009-2011 **Mathematics Teacher**, Ruleville Central High School
Teach for America

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Manuscripts:

1. **Niemiec, E.**, Fields, A., Vannucci, A., Abramson, L.A., Bloom, P.A., Camacho, N.L., Choy, T., Durazi, A., Gibson, L., Hadis, S.H., Harmon, C., Heleniak, C., Umbach, R., VanTieghem, M., Dozier, M., Milham, M.P., & Tottenham, N. Adolescent-specific adaptations to caregiving unpredictability: a longitudinal examination of cognitive flexibility. *Developmental Psychology* (2026). [https://doi.org/ 10.1037/dev0002168](https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0002168)
2. **Niemiec, E.**, Insel, C., & Davidow, J.Y. Striatal and hippocampal contributions to value-based learning in adolescence. *Neuropsychopharmacology* 51, 129–135 (2026). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41386-025-02260-7>
3. Yates, T., Sigwebela, S., Seedat, S., Milham, M., du Plessis, S., Abramson, L., **Niemiec, E.**, Worthman, C., Rotheram-Borus, M. J., Salum, G., Franco, A., Zuanazzi, A., Ahmed, F., Gemmell, K., Christodoulou, J., Mhlaba, N., Mqhele, N., Ngalimane, N., Sambudla, A., Tottenham, N., Tomlinson, M. Investigative approaches to resilient emotion regulation development in a South African birth cohort. *Biological Psychiatry Global Open Science*, 100457 (2025). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bpsgos.2025.100457>

Under Review and In Preparation:

1. Abramson, L.*, Vannucci, A.*, Vicioso, C., Juarez, D. G., Joyce, E., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. (Under Review, *Development and Psychopathology*). Caregiving-related early adversities and parental context effects on adolescents' momentary emotion differentiation. Under review: *Development and Psychopathology*.
* denotes shared first authorship

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

1. **Niemiec, E.**, van Rijn, R., Hennessy, R. R., Olafsson, V., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., Aubrey, B. M., Hegefeld, H. M., Morfini, F., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., Braams, B. R.*, Davidow, J. Y.* Associations between prosocial risk-taking and striatal tissue iron: an exploratory analysis in adolescents. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.
* denotes equal contribution

2. Aubrey, B. M., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., **Niemiec, E.**, Hegefeld, H. M., Olafsson, V., Morfini, F., Hennessy, R. R., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., & Davidow, J. Y. Associations between motivated learning and iron in brain tissue across adolescence. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.
3. Juarez, D. G., Vannucci, A., Fields, A., Bloom, P. A., Camacho, N., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Hadis, S., Heleniak, C., Milham, M. P., & Tottenham, N. Reduced fear generalization is associated with amygdala differentiation and is modulated by early caregiving experiences. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.
4. Joyce, E., Vannucci, A., Fields, A., Bloom, P.A., Camacho, N., Choy, T., Durazi, A., Hadis, S., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Heleniak, C., Harmon, C., Van Tieghem, M., Abramson, L., Dozier, M., Milham, M.P., Tottenham, N. Poor inhibitory control following early caregiving adversity is associated with divergent prefrontal cortex development in adolescence: a longitudinal fMRI study. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.
5. Morfini, F., Murch, G., Pidvirny, K., Jaffe, N., Olafsson, V., **Niemiec, E.**, Aubrey, B.M., Whitfield-Gabrieli, S., Auerbach, R.P., Davidow, J.Y., Webb, C.A. Selective association of ventral striatum brain-tissue iron with anhedonia in adolescents at risk for depression. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.
6. Vannucci, A., Yates, T.S., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D., Joyce, E., **Niemiec, E.**, Fields, A., Heleniak, C., Gibson, L., Milham, M.P., Baldassano, C., Tottenham, N. Neural representations of ambiguous social-emotional events in adolescents vary by early caregiving experience. In Meyer, M.L. (chair), Future Directions in Social Learning and Memory [Symposium]. Paper presented at: Social Affective Neuroscience Society; April, 2026; San Diego, CA.
7. Aubrey, B. M., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., **Niemiec, E.**, Hegefeld, H. M., Olafsson, V., Morfini, F., Hennessy, R. R., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., Davidow, J. Y. Associations between motivated learning and iron in brain tissue across adolescence. Poster accepted, not presented due to health reasons: Cognitive Neuroscience Society; March, 2026, Vancouver, BC, Canada.
8. Vannucci, A., DiGiovanni, A., Abramson, L., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D., Joyce, E., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. Alterations in parent-adolescent negative-affect linkage in the real-world following early caregiving adversity. In Abramson, L. (chair), Interpersonal mechanisms linking parent-child interactions, emotional expertise, and adolescents' mental health [Symposium]. Paper presented at: Society for Affective Science; March, 2026; Pittsburg, PA.
9. **Niemiec, E.**, Jain, K., Hennessy, R., Davidow, J.Y. Adolescent risky goal-directed behavior: Introducing CatSnax, a novel behavioral paradigm examining (pro)social and altruistic risky

actions. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2025; Dublin, Ireland.

10. Vannucci, A., Fields, A., Bloom, P.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Heleniak, C., Gibson, L., Hadis, S.S., Camacho, N.L., Durazi, A., Choy, T., VanTieghem, M., Milham, M.P.*, Tottenham, N.* Longitudinal evidence of altered frontostriatal inhibitory control development following caregiving-related early adversity. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2025; Dublin, Ireland. *these senior authors contributed equally to this work
11. Abramson Vaisman, L., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D.G., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Early caregiving adversity mitigates later associations between parental contexts and adolescents' momentary emotion granularity. Poster presented at: Society for Affective Science; March, 2025; Portland, OR.
12. Vannucci, A., Yates, T.S., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.**, Juarez, D.G., Joyce, E., Gibson, L., Milham, M.P., Baldassano, C., Tottenham, N. Neural representations of shared attachment schemas in adolescents following caregiving related early adversity. Poster presented at: Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2024; Baltimore, MD.
13. Gavrilova, N., Bloom, Paul A., **Niemiec, E.**, Vannucci, A., Camacho, N. L., Choy, T., Heleniak, C., Hadis, S., Gibson, L., Fields, A., Harmon, C., Tottenham, N. Longitudinal associations between executive function and anxiety in youth exposed to heterogeneous caregiving-related early adversities. Poster presented at: Teachers College Institute of Psychological Science and Practice Conference; April, 2024; New York, NY.
14. Abramson, L., Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D.G., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. Adolescents' momentary emotion differentiation varies by social context and caregiving history. Poster presented at: Society for Affective Science; March, 2024; New Orleans, LA.
15. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Joyce, E., Juarez, D. G., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Parental unpredictability is associated with broader medial prefrontal-subcortical circuitry recruitment during affective schema processing in human development. Poster presented at: Society for Neuroscience; November, 2023; Washington, DC.
16. Abramson, L., Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D.G., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. The development of emotion differentiation following early caregiving adversities. Poster presented at: Developmental Affective Neuroscience Symposium; November, 2023; Pittsburgh, PA.
17. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Juarez, D.G., Joyce, E., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Neural meaning making of early caregiving experiences: the developmental neurobiology of affective semantic memory. Poster presented at: Federation

of European Neuroscience Societies (FENS) Brain Conference on Structuring Knowledge for Flexible Behavior; October, 2023; Rungsted Kyst, Denmark.

18. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L. A., **Niemiec, E.**, Juarez, D. G., Joyce, E., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Midline cortico-amygdala circuitry supports affective semantic memory processes during development. Poster presented at: Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2023; Santa Rosa, California.
19. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Juarez, D. G., Joyce, E., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Neural meaning making of early caregiving experiences: the developmental neurobiology of affective semantic memory. Paper presented at: International Society for Developmental Psychobiology; July, 2023; Utrecht, Netherlands.
20. **Niemiec, E.**, Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Tottenham, N. Non-parental adult mentorship and anxious behaviors in school-age children with and without caregiving-related early adversities: support for the developmental match/mismatch hypothesis. Virtual Poster presented at: Harvard Women in Psychology Trends in Psychology; November, 2021.
21. **Niemiec, E.**, Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Tottenham, N. Mentorship and the developing mind: links to anxious behaviors in children with early caregiving adversities. Virtual Data Blitz presentation at: Summer Internship Program in Psychological Science; August, 2021.
22. **Niemiec, E.**, Clayton, T.S. *Saeva modesta*: The Tacitean Female in Shakespeare's *Titus Andronicus*. Paper presented at: Miami University Undergraduate Classics Conference; March, 2009; Oxford, Ohio.

AWARDS & HONORS

2009	<i>Magna cum Laude</i> , University of Minnesota Twin Cities
2008-2009	Top Five Female Student Athlete, University of Minnesota Twin Cities
2006-2009	Collegiate Rowing Coaches Association Scholar Athlete
2006-2009	Big Ten Academic All-Conference Team Member
2005-2009	Dean's List, University of Minnesota Twin Cities

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT & OUTREACH

2026	How does the developing brain support learning from rewards? post in PsychPress: Graduate Voices in Science blog
2026-present	Vice President, Graduate Student Association, Psychology Department, Northeastern University
2026-present	Graduate School Mentoring Program, Northeastern University, Mentor
2026-present	College of Science Student Diversity Advisory Council Mentoring Program
2025-present	Graduate Student Association Organizing Committee (Resources), Psychology Department, Northeastern University
2025-present	Northeastern University Community Liaisons for Education Using STEM (NUCLEUS)
2025-present	Letters to a Pre-Scientist STEM Pen-Pal

2025-2026 NSF Young Scholars' Program Mentor, Northeastern University
2026 "Stress and the Adolescent Brain: Challenges and Advantages of a Growing Brain" presentation at Boston Latin Academy, Boston, MA
2025 "Adolescent Learning and Goal Directed Behavior" presentation at Boston College, Boston, MA, NSF-sponsored high school outreach event
2025 "What It's Like to Be a Brain Researcher" presentation at Boston Latin Academy, Boston, MA
2025 Graduate School Mentoring Program, Northeastern University, Volunteer Speaker
2024 Application Statement Feedback Program ([ASFP](#)) Volunteer Editor
2024 Girls Science Day Volunteer, Columbia University, New York, NY
2023 Genspace and Apex for Youth Brain Awareness Mini-Carnival Volunteer, New York, NY
2023 MindBoggling Exhibit Volunteer, The School At Columbia Science Expo, New York, NY
2021 Co-Mentor, BRAINYAC Program

MEMBERSHIPS IN PROFESSIONAL AND SCIENTIFIC SOCIETIES

2026-present Society for Philosophy and Neuroscience
2026-present International Society for Moral Psychology
2025-present Flux Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience
2025-present Cognitive Neuroscience Society
2025-present Boston Area Neuroscience Group

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Neuroimaging: fMRI acquisition and preprocessing, FSL, Freesurfer, BIDS formatting

Programming languages and statistical analysis: R, Python, SPSS

Data collection tools: PsychoPy, REDCap, Qualtrics, Gorilla, E-Prime

Open Science: GitHub, OSF

Certifications: Level 3 functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI), HIPAA/CITI